

1923

GERMAN MARK COLLAPSES

Harsh reparations were imposed on Germany after World War I. By 1922, the country was unable to meet the payments, prompting French and Belgian forces to occupy the Ruhr, Germany's industrial heartland. The economy collapsed, the Government overprinted money, and the mark plummeted in value, becoming almost worthless.

▷ 100,000 Mark banknote, printed in 1923



In 1922, a loaf of bread in Germany cost 163 marks; by 1923 it cost 200,000,000

1922 **Howard Carter**, a British archaeologist, uncovers the tomb of Egyptian pharaoh Tutankhamun

1923 **General Primo de Rivera** overthrows the Spanish government and takes power as a dictator

1924



△ The signing of the Anglo-Irish treaty

1922

IRISH FREE STATE FORMS

After years of fighting between the Irish Republican Army (IRA) and British forces, the Anglo-Irish Treaty created the Irish Free State as a self-governing dominion within the British Empire. The six counties of Northern Ireland remained part of the UK. The treaty split the republican movement, leading to civil war.



1924 The American composer **George Gershwin** creates *Rhapsody in Blue*

◁ **Mustafa Kemal Atatürk**, first President of Turkey

1923

TURKEY BECOMES A REPUBLIC

Following World War I, the Treaty of Sèvres effectively dismantled the Ottoman Empire, ceding large areas to France, Greece, Italy, and the UK. Led by Mustafa Kemal Atatürk, Turkish nationalists waged a series of wars against the occupiers, particularly the Greeks. The last Ottoman sultan abdicated and, victorious, Kemal declared Turkey a republic, with himself as president.